

Yoana Churkina

UX Designer | Product Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

UX Researcher and Product Designer with hands-on experience leading qualitative research across complex B2B SaaS and AI-driven products. Conducting user interviews, usability testing, discovery research, and research synthesis to translate user needs into clear, actionable product decisions. Comfortable with ambiguous problem spaces, defining research direction, and collaborating closely with cross-functional technical and non-technical teams. Master's in Data-Driven Design, with a focus on how user behaviour, trust, privacy, and data influence product experiences.

EXPERIENCE

Shift Leader - Normal | Sept 2024 - June 2026 | the Netherlands

- Managed **daily operations**, task distribution, and team activities in a fast-paced, customer-facing environment.
- **Prioritised tasks** and supported team members with day-to-day issues and operational decisions to keep workflows running smoothly.
- **Onboarded new team members** and communicated procedures, expectations, and responsibilities across the team.

UX Designer (Intern) - MediaCampusNL | Sept 2024 - July 2025 | the Netherlands

- Worked on an **AI-supported platform for Dutch media start-ups**, designed to help founders explore, validate, and develop new business ideas.
- Conducted discovery research, user interviews, and usability testing to understand how users evaluate ideas, interact with AI recommendations, and perceive **trust and privacy** when sharing sensitive business information.
- Synthesised qualitative research findings into actionable product insights, contributing to features such as **incognito mode and explicit opt-out controls** to address user concerns around privacy and data sharing.
- Iteratively evaluated and refined the product through usability testing, increasing task success to **80–95%** and SUS score from **67.5 to 83.75**.
- Led the UX process from research and problem framing through personas, task flows, prototyping, and evaluation.

UX Designer - Simptel | Feb 2024 - July 2024 | the Netherlands

- Analysed identity and authentication processes and designed a **low-code workflow builder** enabling business users to configure authentication flows without developer involvement.
- Translated business, user, and technical requirements into workflow specifications and functional design solutions for registration, authentication, account recovery, and MFA.
- Collaborated with developers and stakeholders to validate technical feasibility and improve complex B2B SaaS workflows.
- Reduced authentication flow implementation time from approximately **one week to one–two days** by simplifying configuration processes.
- Conducted usability testing and created documentation, wireframes, and high-fidelity Figma prototypes, iterating solutions based on user feedback.

UX Designer (Intern) — Bosch Security & Systems | Aug 2022 – Jan 2023 | the Netherlands

- Conducted user research and market analysis for Bosch's **Future of Conference** project, exploring how non-technical users could manage complex audio/video meeting configurations.
- Identified user needs and pain points around **manual JSON-based configuration**, translating research findings into requirements for a more accessible visual solution.
- Designed and validated a visual interface that enabled users to configure meeting setups without directly working with JSON.
- Collaborated with designers, developers, and technical stakeholders to translate user needs into a feasible digital solution.
- Designed and implemented the interface using **React and CSS**; the solution is now deployed by municipalities and government organisations worldwide.

EDUCATION

Master's, Data-Driven Design

Utrecht University of Applied Sciences | 2024–2025

UX research · Data Science · Data-informed design · AI-driven products · Behavioural analysis

Bachelor's, Information Technology & Media Design

Fontys University of Applied Sciences | 2020–2024

UX/UI design · Interaction design · Technology · Digital product development

Minor, Brand Experience & Event Design

Utrecht University of Applied Sciences

SKILLS

- **UX Research:** Qualitative research, user interviews, usability testing, discovery research, evaluative research, research synthesis, user needs analysis, journey mapping

- **Research & Product:** Problem framing, research planning, personas, task analysis, stakeholder collaboration, data-informed design, product discovery
- **Tools:** Figma, FigJam, Miro, Google Analytics, Jira, Azure DevOps, GitHub
- **Design:** Prototyping, interaction design, design systems, WCAG accessibility
- **Technical:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Python, JSON

CERTIFICATIONS

UI Advanced - SoftUni Creative | UX Advanced - SoftUni Creative

LANGUAGES

Bulgarian (Native) | English (Full Professional) | Dutch (Elementary)